

Personal Security Policy

A governance document that serves as a north star for guiding information security management.

Owner
[Your Name]

Created
[YYYY-MM-DD]

Version
1.0

1. DEVICE SCOPE

All devices considered in scope for this policy. Update whenever devices are added or retired.

Type	Name / Model	OS & Version	Serial Number	FDE	Supported
Laptop	[MacBook Pro M1]	[macOS 15.x]	[123-XYZ]	✓	✓
Phone	[iPhone 15]	[iOS 18.x]	[123-XYZ]	✓	✓
Router	[Model]	[Firmware x]	[123-XYZ]	—	✓

2. DATA CLASSIFICATION

Critical

Loss or exposure causes serious harm.
Requires 3-2-1 backup and encryption.

- Financial records (tax, banking)
- Legal documents (wills, contracts)
- Identity documents (passport, SSN)
- Password vault / private keys
- Irreplaceable personal files
- [Add your own]
- [Add your own]

Sensitive

Exposure is damaging; loss is painful
but survivable. Requires two copies.

- Personal photos and videos
- Email archive
- Health and medical records
- Personal correspondence
- [Add your own]
- [Add your own]

Replaceable

Can be reinstalled or regenerated.
Basic single backup is sufficient.

- Installed applications
- Cached and temporary data
- Downloaded media
- OS configuration
- [Add your own]

3. PERSONAL THREAT MODEL

Document only threats that realistically apply and the primary mitigation against them.

Threat	Likelihood	Impact	Primary Mitigation
Credential stuffing	HIGH	MEDIUM	Unique passwords + HIBP monitoring
Phishing	HIGH	HIGH	Hardware key MFA on high-value accounts
Device theft / loss	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	FDE + remote wipe configured
Opportunistic malware	MEDIUM	HIGH	AV, DNS filtering, limited installs
Ransomware	LOW	HIGH	Air-gapped offline backup

Financial fraud	MEDIUM	MEDIUM	Transaction alerts + credit freeze
[Custom threat]			

4. ACCEPTED RISKS

Every deliberate security tradeoff must be documented here. An undocumented risk is an oversight, not an acceptance.

Risk 1 — [SMS MFA on bank account — TOTP not supported]

Review by: [YYYY-MM-DD]

Justification: [Bank does not offer hardware key or TOTP. Mitigated by transaction alerts and monthly account review.]

Risk 2 — [Device X is end-of-life — replacement planned]

Review by: [YYYY-MM-DD]

Justification: [Budget constraint. Device not used for sensitive tasks. Replacement scheduled for [Month Year].]

Risk 3 — [Add accepted risk]

Review by: [YYYY-MM-DD]

Justification: [Justification and mitigating controls.]

5. SECURITY TOOLING REGISTER

Recovery keys and credentials should be secured elsewhere — record reference locations only here.

Category	Tool	Notes / Recovery Location	Last Audited
Password manager	[Bitwarden / 1Password]	Emergency sheet at: [location]	[YYYY-MM-DD]
MFA authenticator	[Aegis / Raivo]	Encrypted backup at: [location]	[YYYY-MM-DD]
Hardware key	[YubiKey 5 — 2×]	Backup key stored at: [location]	[YYYY-MM-DD]
Local backup	[Time Machine / rsync]	External drive at: [location]	[YYYY-MM-DD]
Cloud backup	[Backblaze / Restic+B2]	Encryption key: in vault	[YYYY-MM-DD]
DNS filtering	[NextDNS / Pi-hole]	Config ID: [ID] — in vault	[YYYY-MM-DD]
VPN	[Mullvad / ProtonVPN]	Account credentials: in vault	[YYYY-MM-DD]
Breach monitoring	HIBP	All email addresses enrolled	[YYYY-MM-DD]
Outbound firewall	[Little Snitch / Lulu]	Rule backup at: [location]	[YYYY-MM-DD]
Credit monitoring	[Service name]	All three bureaus enrolled	[YYYY-MM-DD]
[Add]			[YYYY-MM-DD]

6. REVIEW & AUDIT LOG

Record every review. A log that isn't maintained is a policy that isn't being practiced.

Date	Type	Findings	Actions Taken
[YYYY-MM-DD]	Annual	Initial policy created	All sections completed
	Ad-hoc		
	Annual		

7. BACKUP RESTORE TEST LOG

Test backup restore at least quarterly. Document the date, backup source, scope, result, and any relevant notes.

Date	Source	File / Scope Restored	Pass/ Fail	Notes	Integrity Check
	Local backup		✓		✓
	Cloud backup		?		?
	Local backup				
	Cloud backup				
	Local backup				
	Cloud backup				
[YYYY-MM-DD]	Full rehearsal	Complete system restore	✓	Annual — bare metal	✓

8. INCIDENT LOG

Every security event, however minor. Record what happened, how it was handled, and what changed as a result.

Date	Type	What Happened	Response	Changes Made
[YYYY-MM-DD]				

9. EMERGENCY REFERENCE

Print this section and store with physical secure documents. Reference locations only — no credentials here.

Password Manager

Manager: Bitwarden / 1Password / KeePass

Master password at: Physical location — not the password

Financial Emergency

Primary bank fraud line: Number on card

Credit card fraud line: Number on card

Credit freeze PINs at: Location — not the PINs

Emergency contact: *Name and how to reach them* _____

Backup codes at: *Physical location* _____

Primary Email Recovery

Provider: *Gmail / iCloud / other* _____

Recovery phone: *Last 4 digits only* _____

Backup email: *Address* _____

Backup codes at: *Physical location* _____

Device Remote Lock / Wipe

Apple Find My: *icloud.com/find* _____

Google Find My Device: *android.com/find* _____

Microsoft Find My Device: *account.microsoft.com/devices* _____

Credit Bureau Freeze

- ☐ Equifax — 1-800-349-9960
- ☐ Experian — 1-888-397-3742
- ☐ TransUnion — 1-888-909-8872

Store the digital version encrypted in your password manager. Print Section 9 and keep it in a fireproof safe or with your legal documents. Rewrite Sections 1–4 at every annual review.